

warned in a dream, he withdrew to the district of Galilee, ²³and he went and lived in a town called Nazareth. So was fulfilled what was spoken through the prophets: “He will be called a Nazarene.”

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1-5; Mark 1:1-8; Luke 3:1-20; John 1:19-28



¹ In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea

² and saying, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is near.” ³ This is he who was spoken of through the prophet Isaiah:

“A voice of one calling in the wilderness,

‘Prepare the way for the Lord,
make straight paths for Him.’”^a

⁴ John wore a garment of camel’s hair, with a leather belt around his waist. His food was locusts and wild honey. ⁵ People went out to him from Jerusalem and all Judea and the whole region around the Jordan. ⁶ Confessing their sins, they were baptized by him in the Jordan River.

⁷ But when John saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming to his place of baptism, he said to them, “You brood of vipers, who warned you to flee from the coming wrath? ⁸ Produce fruit, then, in keeping with repentance. ⁹ And do not presume to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our father.’ For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham. ¹⁰ The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

¹¹ I baptize you with water^b for repentance, but after me will come One more powerful than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire.^c ¹² His winnowing fork is in His hand to clear His threshing floor and to gather His wheat into the barn; but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.”

The Baptism of Jesus

Mark 1:9-11; Luke 3:21-22; John 1:29-34

¹³ At that time Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to be baptized by John. ¹⁴ But John tried to prevent Him, saying, “I need to be baptized by You, and do You come to me?”

¹⁵ “Let it be so now,” Jesus replied. “It is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness in this way.” Then John permitted Him.

^a Isaiah 40:3 (see also LXX) ^b Or in water ^c Or in the Holy Spirit and in fire

16 As soon as Jesus was baptized, He went up out of the water. Suddenly the heavens were opened,^a and He saw^b the Spirit of God descending like a dove and resting on Him. **17** And a voice from heaven said, “This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased!”

The Temptation of Jesus

Mark 1:12–13; Luke 4:1–13

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1 Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.

2 After fasting forty days and forty nights, He was hungry.

3 The tempter came to Him and said, “If You are the Son of God, tell these stones to become bread.”

4 But Jesus answered, “It is written:

‘Man shall not live on bread alone,

but on every word that comes from the mouth of God.’^c”

5 Then the devil took Him to the holy city and set Him on the pinnacle of the temple. **6** “If You are the Son of God,” he said, “throw Yourself down. For it is written:

‘He will command His angels concerning You,

and they will lift You up in their hands,

so that You will not strike Your foot

against a stone.’^d”

7 Jesus replied, “It is also written: ‘Do not put the Lord your God to the test.’^e”

8 Again, the devil took Him to a very high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. **9** “All this I will give You,” he said, “if You will fall down and worship me.”

10 “Away from Me, Satan!” Jesus told him. “For it is written: ‘Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only.’^f”

11 Then the devil left Him, and angels came and ministered to Him.

Jesus Begins His Ministry

Isaiah 9:1–7; Mark 1:14–15; Luke 4:14–15

12 When Jesus heard that John had been imprisoned, He withdrew to Galilee. **13** Leaving Nazareth, He went and lived in Capernaum, which is by the sea in the region of Zebulun and Naphtali, **14** to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah:

^a NA, BYZ, and TR *the heavens were opened to Him* ^b Or *and he saw*; see John 1:32–33|JHN 1:32–33. ^c Deuteronomy 8:3 ^d Psalm 91:11–12 ^e Deuteronomy 6:16 ^f Deuteronomy 6:13

²¹ But Jesus was speaking about the temple of His body. ²² After He was raised from the dead, His disciples remembered that He had said this. Then they believed the Scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken. ²³ While He was in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, many people saw the signs He was doing and believed in His name. ²⁴ But Jesus did not entrust Himself to them, for He knew them all. ²⁵ He did not need any testimony about man, for He knew what was in a man.

Jesus and Nicodemus

Genesis 22:1–10; Romans 5:6–11

3

¹ Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews.

² He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs You are doing if God were not with him.”

³ Jesus replied, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.^a”

⁴ “How can a man be born when he is old?” Nicodemus asked. “Can he enter his mother’s womb a second time to be born?”

⁵ Jesus answered, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit. ⁶ Flesh is born of flesh, but spirit is born of the Spirit. ⁷ Do not be amazed that I said, ‘You^b must be born again.’ ⁸ The wind blows where it wishes. You hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”

⁹ “How can this be?” Nicodemus asked.

¹⁰ “You are Israel’s teacher,” said Jesus, “and you do not understand these things? ¹¹ Truly, truly, I tell you, we speak of what we know, and we testify to what we have seen, and yet you people do not accept our testimony.

¹² If I have told you about earthly things and you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you about heavenly things? ¹³ No one has ascended into heaven except the One who descended from heaven— the Son of Man.^c ¹⁴ Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, ¹⁵ that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.^d

¹⁶ For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only^e Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For

^a Or *born from above*; also in verse 7. ^b The Greek word for *you* is plural; also in verse 12.

^c BYZ and TR include *who is in heaven*. ^d Or *everyone who believes may have eternal life in Him*. ^e Or *only begotten or unique*; also in verse 18

33 Little children, I am with you only a little while longer. You will look for Me, and as I said to the Jews, so now I say to you: ‘Where I am going, you cannot come.’

34 A new commandment I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you also must love one another. **35** By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another.”

Jesus Predicts Peter’s Denial

Matthew 26:31-35; Mark 14:27-31; Luke 22:31-38

36 “Lord, where are You going?” Simon Peter asked.

Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you cannot follow Me now, but you will follow later.”

37 “Lord,” said Peter, “why can’t I follow You now? I will lay down my life for You.”

38 “Will you lay down your life for Me?” Jesus replied. “Truly, truly, I tell you, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.”^[1]

In My Father’s House Are Many Rooms



¹ “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God;^a believe in Me as well.

2 In My Father’s house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you?^b **3** And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am. **4** You know the way to the place where I am going.”^c

The Way, the Truth, and the Life

5 “Lord,” said Thomas, “we do not know where You are going, so how can we know the way?”

6 Jesus answered, “I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me. **7** If you had known Me, you would know My Father as well. From now on you do know Him and have seen Him.”

8 Philip said to Him, “Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us.”

9 Jesus replied, “Philip, I have been with you all this time, and still you do not know Me? Anyone who has seen Me has seen the Father. How can you say, ‘Show us the Father’? **10** Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me? The words I say to you, I do not speak on My own. Instead, it is the Father dwelling in Me, performing His works. **11** Believe

^a Or Believe in God ^b Or If it were not so, I would have told you. I am going there to prepare a place for you. ^c BYZ and TR And where I go you know, and the way you know.